Interview Questions

Goal of this survey:

Understanding the degree of information sharing and the sensitivity of information sharing for users on social coding platforms with regards to different identity factors.

Determining the intent of the users of social coding platforms for anonymity.

Determining the balance cost model of anonymity in comparison to professional benefits and visibility.

Participant background

The behavior of developers on social coding platforms is impacted by variety of demographic, cultural, and personal factors. In this part, we would like to ask for your demographic information helping us to contextualize the research results. These information (and any other information in this interview) would not be used individually and will only be reported in aggregation. We will treat this information with utmost confidentiality and discard these responses after aggregation and reporting.

Participation in this interview is voluntary and you may leave the interview at any point desired.

Q1. What is your current professional role or job title?

Q2. What country do you currently reside?

Follow-up: What province (state) do you currently reside?

- Alberta
- British Columbia
- Manitoba
- New Brunswick
- Newfoundland and Labrador
- Nova Scotia
- Ontario
- Prince Edward Island (PEI)
- Quebec
- Saskatchewan
- Northwest Territories, Nunavut, or Yukon
- Other (please specify here):
- Prefer not to answer.

Q3. How many years of experience do you have in software development?

- 0-1 year
- 1-2 years
- 2-3 years
- 3-4 years

- 4-5 years
- More than 5 years
- Prefer not to answer

Q4. What is your self-identified gender?

- Male
- Female
- Non-binary
- Other (please specify)
- Prefer not to answer

Anonymity and participation

Q5. How would you describe being anonymous online?

Q6. What profile information are the most important for you to protect your anonymity?

Q7. Why are these profile information the most important for you to protect your anonymity?

Q8. Can you elaborate on situations or interactions (activities) where you find anonymity to be crucial on these platforms?

Q9. Can you discuss how the anonymity of others influences your decision in terms of sharing information on platforms or engaging with them?

Q10. Do you think that having multiple accounts assists with your anonymity on these platforms?

Identity and account use

Q11. Are you anonymous based on the definition we discussed on any of your social media, social coding platforms or professional network accounts?

Q12. (If yes) Can you elaborate on the specific reasons for maintaining anonymity on these platforms?

Q13. How important is it for you to remain anonymous on these platforms (on a scale of 1, not important, to 5, extremely important)?

Q14. Do you use your real photo on your social media? What about on the social coding platforms and professional networks you mentioned?

Q15. What social media, social coding profiles, professional networks have you included in your resume or CV?

Q16. Why have you included these social media, social coding profiles, or professional networks in your resume or CV?

Q17. Do you have multiple accounts on your social media apps or social coding platforms?

Q18. Can you explain your reasons behind whether or not maintaining multiple accounts on these platforms?

Privacy policies

Q19. Which of the privacy policies, either Stack Overflow's or GitHub's, have you read?

Q20. (If neither policy has been read) Can you share the reasons on why you have not read these privacy policies?

Q21. How much time would it take you to read Stack Overflow’s privacy policy?

Interviewer instruction: For Stack Overflow we could retrieve 12 pages of privacy policy on personal data. Here I have a print. How much time would it take you to read this? ….. as we are

doing a controlled study I am going to ask you read this document to the best you can in 10 minutes and highlight any parts that are most important for you.

After the 10 min is over…., Given now that you have read it,…..

Q22. How likely is it for you to indeed read through this policy fully (1 being not likely at all and 5 being extremely likely)?

Q23. For you, what was the most important policy in Stack Overflow's privacy policy?

Q24. How much time would it take you to read GitHub's privacy policy?

Interviewer instruction: For GitHub we could retrieve 5 pages of privacy policy on personal data. Here I have a print. How much time would it take you to read this? ….. as we are doing a controlled study I am going to ask you read this document to the best you can in 5 minutes and highlight any parts that are most important for you.

After the 5 min is over…., Given now that you have read it,….

Q25. How likely is it for you to indeed read through this policy fully? Why this more likely than when you read stack overflow's privacy policy?(1 being not likely at all and 5 being extremely likely)?

Q26. For you, was the most important policy in GitHub's Privacy Policy?

Contextual integrity

To make sure that the users understand the privacy policy, we are investigating the use of contextual integrity (CI). We restructured these policies using CI. The theory of privacy as contextual integrity (CI) introduces three key concepts into the privacy vocabulary: information flow (sender, subject, recipient, attribute, transmission principle(reason).

Here is the table of the privacy policy using CI for Stack Overflow, after manually annotating them using Contextual Integrity from the section of the privacy policy which was coded under Personal data.

Q27. How would you rank these in order of importance in terms of which ones would you care to be notified of first, second and so on?

Here is the table of the privacy policy using CI for GitHub after manually annotating them using Contextual Integrity from the section of the privacy policy which was coded under Personal data.

Q28. How would you rank these in order of importance in terms of which ones would you care to be notified of first, second and so on?

Q29. Do you believe adding the CI structure helped you with understanding of these policies?

Q30. How likely would you read Stack Overflow's policy if it were structured as such (1 being not likely at all and 5 being extremely likely)?

Q31. How likely would you read GitHub's policy if it were structured as such (1 being not likely at all and 5 being extremely likely)?

Supplementary questions and prompts

1. What is your age range?

   Under 18

   18-24

   25-34

   35-44

   45-54

   55-64

   65 and over

   Prefer not to answer

2. What is your sexual orientation?

   Asexual

   Bisexual

   Gay

   Lesbian

   Queer

   Questioning

   Straight (Heterosexual)

   Two-Spirit

   Pansexual

   Other (please specify)

   Prefer not to answer

3. What is your Race/Ethnicity?

   White (eg: German, Irish, English, Italian, Polish, French, etc.)

Hispanic, Latino or Spanish origin (e.g. Mexican or Mexican American, Puerto Rican, Cuban, Salvadoran, Dominican, Colombian, etc.)

Black or African American (e.g. African American, Jamaican, Haitian, Nigerian, Ethiopian, Somalian, etc.)

Asian (e.g. Chinese, Filipino, Asian Indian, Vietnamese, Korean, Japanese, etc)

American Indian or Alaska Native (e.g. Navajo nation, Blackfeet tribe, Mayan, Aztec, Native Village or Barrow Inupiat Traditional Government, Nome Eskimo Community, etc.)

Middle Eastern or North African (e.g. Lebanese, Iranian, Egyptian, Syrian, Moroccan, Algerian, etc.)

Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander (e.g. Native Hawaiian, Samoan, Chamorro, Tongan, Fijian, etc.)

Other race, ethnicity, or origin (please specify):

Prefer not to answer

Do you identify as Indigenous?

Yes. (please specify)

First Nations

Metis

Inuit

Other (please specify)

No

Prefer not to answer

4. Do you consider yourself as having a disability?

   Yes

   No

   Prefer not to answer

5. Can you provide us with your Stack Overflow and GitHub username?
6. What social media apps do you use?
7. Can you please list the social coding platforms and professional networks that you use, specifically relevant to your profession?
8. How often (on average) do you update your information on social coding profiles (On a scale of 1 (being rarely) to 5 (being very frequently and as any change is happening)?

   - 1: Rarely
   - 2: Occasionally
   - 3: Moderately

- 4: Frequently
- 5: Very Frequently

9. Do you have verified accounts on the platforms in any of your social media, social coding platforms or professional networks? if yes which ones, and if not why?
10. If it was required to verify your Stack Overflow and GitHub profiles how would that impact your activity on each platform?
11. To what extent have you read the privacy polices in depth to understand the implications for your personal information and content? While 1 being skimming the policy and 5 being in all details.

    (if 1 yes) Currently, to what extent do you remember each policy (for Stack Overflow or GitHub)?

    - Not at all
    - Vaguely
    - Moderately
    - Quite well
    - Extremely well

Closing

Can you please fill in the demographics …

Thank you for your time!